

Team Member Profiles

Senior and Mid-Level Consulting Staff — Selected Profiles

Priya Natarajan

Senior Engagement Partner | Operations Practice | Chicago, IL

Priya joined CRCG in 2014 and leads the firm's Operations Excellence practice. She specializes in plant-floor digitization and supply chain resilience, with particular depth in discrete manufacturing.

Experience

- Senior Engagement Partner, Cobalt Ridge Consulting Group (2014–present)
- Operations Manager, a Midwest industrial pump manufacturer (2010–2014)
- Process Engineer, an automotive Tier 1 supplier (2007–2010)

Education & Certifications

- M.S., Industrial Engineering, Purdue University
- Lean Six Sigma Black Belt
- Project Management Professional (PMP)

Notable Engagements

- Atlas Manufacturing Plant Floor Digitization, Phases 1 & 2 (Engagement Lead)
- Brightline Retail Supply Chain Resilience Assessment (Engagement Lead)

Samuel Kestrel

Senior Engagement Partner | Digital Practice | Denver, CO

Samuel joined CRCG in 2015 and built the firm's Digital & Analytics practice from a single-person function into a 35-person team. He focuses on interoperability programs in regulated industries and large-scale predictive analytics builds.

Experience

- Senior Engagement Partner, Cobalt Ridge Consulting Group (2015–present)
- Senior Manager, Data & Analytics, a national health system (2012–2015)
- Data Engineer, a healthcare technology startup (2009–2012)

Education & Certifications

- M.S., Computer Science, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
- B.S., Applied Mathematics, University of Wisconsin–Madison

- Certified HL7 FHIR Implementer
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect

Notable Engagements

- NovaHealth Clinical Data Interoperability Program (Engagement Lead)
- Helios Energy Grid Asset Digital Twin Roadmap and Phase 2 Field Operations Platform (Engagement Lead)
- Recognized as a “40 Under 40 Consulting Leader” by Consulting Quarterly Magazine, 2023

Hana Brennan-Cole

Lead Data Strategist | Digital Practice | Toronto, ON

Hana joined CRCG in 2018 and leads model development for predictive analytics and forecasting engagements across the Digital & Analytics practice's North American client base.

Experience

- Lead Data Strategist, Cobalt Ridge Consulting Group (2018–present)
- Data Scientist, a Canadian retail analytics firm (2015–2018)

Education & Certifications

- M.S., Statistics, University of Toronto
- Google Professional Data Engineer

Notable Engagements

- Brightline Retail Store Replenishment Forecasting Pilot (Workstream Lead)
- Helios Energy Phase 2 Field Operations Platform (Workstream Lead)

Tobias Lindqvist

Engagement Manager | Public & Financial Services | Austin, TX

Tobias joined CRCG in 2017 and leads engagements spanning regulated financial services and public sector clients, with a focus on operational risk and asset management modernization.

Experience

- Engagement Manager, Cobalt Ridge Consulting Group (2017–present)
- Risk Analyst, a regional bank holding company (2014–2017)

Education & Certifications

- MBA, University of Texas at Austin
- B.A., Economics, Trinity University

- Financial Risk Manager (FRM)

Notable Engagements

- Meridian Trust Bank Operational Risk Controls Uplift (Engagement Lead)
- City of Beaumont Public Works Asset Management Modernization (Engagement Lead)

Marcus Eldridge

Senior Consultant | Operations Practice | Chicago, IL

Marcus joined CRCG in 2019 and has supported plant-floor digitization and supply chain engagements across the manufacturing and retail sectors.

Experience

- Senior Consultant, Cobalt Ridge Consulting Group (2019–present)
- Manufacturing Engineer, a consumer electronics contract manufacturer (2016–2019)

Education & Certifications

- B.S., Mechanical Engineering, Georgia Institute of Technology
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt

Notable Engagements

- Atlas Manufacturing Plant Floor Digitization, Phase 2 (core team)

Grant Oyelaran

Risk & Compliance Lead | Public & Financial Services | Toronto, ON

Grant joined CRCG in 2020 and leads control design and regulatory readiness workstreams for financial services and insurance clients.

Experience

- Risk & Compliance Lead, Cobalt Ridge Consulting Group (2020–present)
- Compliance Manager, a national insurance carrier (2016–2020)
- Examiner, a provincial financial regulator (2013–2016)

Education & Certifications

- J.D., Osgoode Hall Law School
- B.Comm., Queen's University
- Certified Regulatory Compliance Manager (CRCM)

Notable Engagements

- Meridian Trust Bank Operational Risk Controls Uplift (Control Design Lead)